

Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Isabella and Ferdinand: government	The situation in Spain in 1469; campaign to secure the throne by 1479; administrative methods; control of the nobility and towns; law and order; finances; trade and economy: customs barriers; similarities and differences in the rule of Castile and Aragon; extent of unification and 'New Monarchy'; powers of the monarchs; Ferdinand's rule after Isabella's death; the situation in 1516.
Isabella and Ferdinand: religion	The monarchs' religious aims and beliefs; relations with Rome; title 'The Catholic Kings'; La convivencia; the Reconquista; the capture of Granada (1492) and its significance; treatment of the Moriscos and Conversos; Cisneros and church reform; the Inquisition and its impact.
Charles I: government and religion	The succession; administrative methods, inheritance and priorities by 1519; reliance on foreigners; relations with the Spanish nobility and towns, handling of the Comunero and Germania revolts (1519–1524), reasons for stability after 1524; finances; religious developments, Charles I's tolerance to Morisco traditions; relations with Rome; the Polyglot Bible, Illuminism and Erasmianism; Philip as Regent (1540–1555); Charles's abdication (1555).
Overseas policies and the economy	Exploration and discovery; Columbus and the discovery and explorations of the 'Indies', the Caribbean, Hispaniola; Cortes and the Conquest of Mexico (1518–1541); Pizarro and the Conquest of Peru (1524–1541); the economic impact of the New World on Spanish trade and the economy; domestic trade, industry and agriculture; foreign policy: aims and threats, alliances, the Italian Wars, the impact on Spain of Charles I's problems as Holy Roman Emperor.